



USER MANUAL

HSG

Habits · Systems · Goals

A complete reference guide to the HSG application — covering setup,
every page in the app, and the concepts behind it.

EDITION 2

Official User Manual for the HSG Application

Support: rdwerthen@gmail.com



GETTING STARTED

Introduction

HSG (Habits · Systems · Goals) is a personal application for building lasting change through small, repeatable systems rather than willpower alone. This manual describes every section of the application in plain language, with practical guidance for common tasks.



How This Manual Is Organised

- **One chapter per application area.** Each chapter corresponds to a section in the sidebar, in the order it appears in the application. Longer chapters are split across two pages.
- **Callout boxes.** Tips, notes, and cautions appear throughout each chapter to highlight practical guidance.
- **Step-by-step instructions.** Numbered steps are provided for common tasks.
- **An Index.** The following page lists every chapter with its page number for quick reference.

**TIP**

This manual does not need to be read in order. Use the Index to locate the chapter relevant to your current task.



The HSG Approach

Most productivity applications focus on outcomes alone. HSG is organised around three connected layers: the **outcomes** a user wants to reach, the **systems** run daily to reach them, and the **identity** that develops as a result. Every section of the application, from the Dashboard to the Vision Board, is designed to support these three layers together.

**Identity**

Who the user is becoming, reflected in Identity Statements and Core Values.

**Systems**

The repeatable daily actions — habits — that produce progress over time.

**Goals**

The concrete outcomes that systems are working toward.



Basic vs. Advanced Mode

Near the top of the sidebar is a site-mode switch with two options, **Basic** and **Advanced**. Basic mode shows the core, everyday features of each page. Advanced mode reveals additional dashboards, tools, and reference material throughout the application. Every chapter in this manual notes where content is Advanced-mode only.

**NOTE**

HSG is self-hosted: a single HTML file that runs entirely in the browser. All data is stored locally on the user's device, and no server is required unless GitHub Sync is configured in Settings.

Index

Every chapter in this manual, in the order they appear in the HSG sidebar.

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OVERVIEW

Dashboard

The Dashboard is the first page shown after login. It presents a summary of goals, systems, and the current month, so overall progress is visible without navigating through multiple menus.

Insights & Analytics (Advanced Mode)

A grid of small charts near the top of the page gives a deeper look at how things are trending:

WIDGET	WHAT IT SHOWS
Productivity Score	A single composite score summarising recent activity across goals and systems.
Goals by Status	A pie chart of goals split into Not Started, In Progress, Completed, and Overdue.
Goals by Category	A pie chart of goals grouped by the category assigned when each goal was created.
Activity Heatmap	A 12-week grid of system check-ins, similar to a contribution graph, showing consistency at a glance.
Streak Leaderboard	Active systems ranked by current consecutive-day streak.
This Month at a Glance	A compact calendar-style summary of the current month's completions.
Money Snapshot	A short summary pulled from the Finance page's budget data.
Milestones Progress	Progress bars for goals that have milestones defined.

Stat Cards

Four cards beneath the insights grid give an immediate read on where things stand: **Goals Set** (total active goals), **Completed** (with a completion rate), **In Progress**, and **Overdue** (goals past their target date).



TIP

Reviewing the Dashboard briefly at the start of each day is an effective way to confirm today's priorities before starting work.

 Quick Add Bar

A row of one-click buttons lets a new item be created without leaving the Dashboard: **New Goal**, **New System**, **New Checklist**, and **New Vision** (which opens the Vision Board).

 Upcoming Deadlines & Today Panel

The **Upcoming Deadlines** section lists goals and events coming due soon, ordered by date. The **Today** panel beneath it shows everything scheduled for the current day, with a shortcut button into the full Calendar page.

 System Consistency (Advanced Mode)

A bar chart shows each system's consistency within its own tracking window — useful for spotting which habits are slipping before a streak is lost entirely.

 Priority Goals

The bottom of the Dashboard lists active goals as cards, filterable by priority using the **All / High / Medium / Low** pills above the grid.

 Key Principle



WHY IT MATTERS

Systems compound. A habit that improves by a small margin each day produces little visible change on any single day, but repeated consistently, small improvements accumulate into results that a single large effort toward a goal cannot match. This principle underlies the design of HSG.

New Goal button

Productivity Score

Activity Heatmap

Streak Leaderboard

Money Snapshot

System Consistency



IDENTITY-BASED CHANGE

Identity

This chapter covers the core principle behind HSG: lasting change is driven by identity, not only by outcomes. The Identity page is organised into two tabs, **Concepts & Practice** and **Wisdom**, and provides the framework and tools for applying this principle.

The Habit Loop

Every habit, wanted or unwanted, runs on the same four-step loop: a **cue** triggers a **craving**, which drives a **response**, which delivers a **reward**. The Four Laws below each correspond to one step of this loop.

Building a Good Habit: The Four Laws

1 Make the cue obvious

Design surroundings so the trigger is unavoidable.

- Habit-stack: "After [current habit], I will [new habit]."
- Decide the exact time and place in advance.

2 Make it attractive

The more appealing a habit feels, the stronger the craving.

- Temptation-bundle: pair it with something already enjoyed.
- Spend time around people for whom it is already normal.

3 Make it easy

Motivation is unreliable; removing friction is not.

- Two-minute rule: shrink it until it takes under two minutes to start.
- Prime the environment the night before.

4 Make it satisfying

What gets rewarded gets repeated.

- Use a visible win — exactly what the Systems tracker provides.
- Never miss twice in a row.



TIP

To remove an unwanted habit, apply the same four laws in reverse: make the cue invisible, make the habit unattractive, make it difficult, and make it unsatisfying (for example, by telling someone or agreeing to a small penalty for slipping).



Why It Feels Like Nothing Is Happening

Effort invested in a new system climbs steadily from the first day. Visible results, however, typically stay flat for a long stretch before breaking upward all at once, once enough small changes have accumulated beneath the surface. This gap — sometimes called the plateau of latent potential — is where most people stop, right before the curve turns up. It is not a sign that a system has failed; it is the ordinary shape of compounding.



Contents of the Practice Tab

- **Identity Statements** — short, present-tense statements such as "I am becoming someone who...", written as a lens for daily decisions rather than a promise about the future.
- **Core Values** — a short list (fewer than ten works best) of the principles decisions should answer to. These rarely need to change.
- **Evidence Log** — a dated record of moments that prove the identity being built, linked to a specific Identity Statement.
- **Words to Keep You Going** — a searchable gallery of short quotes on goals, discipline, resilience, and identity, filterable by category.



Writing Identity Statements

- 1 Open the **Identity** page from the sidebar and select the **Concepts & Practice** tab.
- 2 Locate **Put It Into Practice: Your Identity Statements**.
- 3 Write a short statement in the form "I am becoming someone who..." for an area of focus.
- 4 Add corresponding entries under **Core Values**, and record supporting entries in the **Evidence Log** as related systems are completed.



The Wisdom Tab

A separate tab offers reference material on identity and character from two traditions: **Biblical Wisdom on Identity & Character** (quotations from the King James Version), and a curated set of secular **Teachings on Identity** from contemporary writers on habits and behaviour change.



NOTE

Identity change occurs gradually. A period with few entries in the Evidence Log does not indicate failure — it typically corresponds to the plateau described above, which resolves with continued, consistent use of the linked systems.



IDENTITY-BASED CHANGE

Systems

If Goals define the intended outcome, Systems define the method. This page contains the repeatable daily actions — habits — that support progress toward every other part of HSG.



Contents of This Chapter

- **Systems Mini-Dashboard** (Advanced mode) — a summary of consistency across active systems.
- **Your Systems** — the list of habits currently being tracked, with daily check-off controls and a running streak count for each.
- **Habit Stacker** — a tool for attaching a new habit to an existing one, in the form "After I [current habit], I will [new habit]."
- **Habit Template Library** — pre-written habit examples, organised by category, that can be added directly with pre-filled tracking settings.
- **Habit & Systems Literature** — supporting concepts, including a short list of simple daily disciplines drawn from established systems-thinking writers.



Using Habit Stacking

- 1 Open the **Systems** page and locate the **Habit Stacker** tool.
- 2 Select a habit already performed reliably each day, such as making coffee.
- 3 Attach the new, small habit immediately after it — for example, "After I pour my coffee, I will write one line in my journal."
- 4 Track the paired habit for at least two weeks before adding further links to the chain.



Tracking Windows

Each system can be set to a tracking frequency — daily, a set number of times per week, or a custom schedule. The Dashboard's System Consistency chart and the Systems Mini-Dashboard both measure performance against this window, rather than against every calendar day, so an intentionally twice-weekly habit is not penalised for the days it is not scheduled.



Habit Template Categories

The Habit Template Library groups its pre-written habits by life area, so a relevant starting point can be found quickly rather than writing one from scratch:

Health & Fitness

Nutrition

Sleep

Productivity

Learning

Finance

Relationships

Mindfulness

Spirituality

Home & Environment

Creativity

**CAUTION**

Avoid adding too many new systems at once. A small number of consistently maintained systems is more effective than a larger number that are abandoned after a few weeks.



IDENTITY-BASED CHANGE

Goals

The Goals page contains the outcomes that daily systems are working toward. It is organised into four tabs: **My Goals**, **Template Library**, **Goal-Setting Tools**, and **Setting Goals Education**.



Goals Mini-Dashboard (Advanced Mode)

Three charts summarise the current goal list: goals **by status**, goals **by category**, and goals **by priority**.



My Goals

The main tab lists every active goal, searchable by title, description, or category, and viewable either as a **List** or as a drag-style **Board** grouped by status.



Template Library

A library of nearly a thousand pre-written goals spanning every area of life, filterable by category, timeframe (short, medium, or long-term), and life phase (teen through senior). Selecting a template adds it to the goal list with milestones already filled in, ready to adjust.

**TIP**

The Template Library is a fast way to get started if a blank goal feels intimidating — find something close to the intended goal, add it, and edit the details afterward.

Goal-Setting Tools

Three structured tools help turn a general intention into a specific, trackable goal:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
SMART Builder	Walks through Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound fields, then assembles the answers into a single goal statement and creates the goal directly.
Milestone Wizard	Takes an existing goal and a chosen number of steps (3–6), and evenly spaces milestone checkpoints between today and the goal's target date.
Impact vs. Effort Matrix	Plots every active goal by progress (a proxy for effort invested) against priority (a proxy for impact), giving a quick visual for where to focus next.

Creating a New Goal

- 1 Select **+ New Goal** from the Dashboard, the Goals page, or the Quick Add bar.
- 2 Enter a clear title, and, where useful, a category and priority level (High, Medium, Low).
- 3 Set a target date if the goal is time-bound; this appears in the Upcoming Deadlines list on the Dashboard.
- 4 Save the goal, then link a System to it so that the goal has a corresponding daily action.

Setting Goals Education

A reference tab covering the research and frameworks behind effective goal-setting, including the cue-craving-response-reward loop, SMARTER metrics, execution algorithms, and horizons of focus, with contributions summarised from writers including James Clear, Michael Hyatt, Brian Tracy, and Napoleon Hill.



NOTE

A goal without an associated system generally does not progress. When adding a goal, identify the smallest daily habit that would move it forward, and add it on the Systems page.



TRACKING

Calendar

The Calendar page anchors systems, goals, and to-do items to specific dates, and provides time-blocking and time-management tools. It is organised into five tabs: **Calendar**, **Calendar Tools**, **Time Blocking & Focus**, **Time Management Tools**, and **Time Management Education**.

 Calendar Views

The main tab switches between **Month**, **Week**, **Year**, and **Agenda** views, with buttons to step backward or forward through the period, jump to **Today**, and export goals with target dates as a standard **.ics** calendar file for use in other calendar applications.

 Calendar Tools

TOOL	WHAT IT SHOWS
Upcoming Deadlines	A wider view of the same list shown on the Dashboard.
Best Days of the Week	A bar chart of which weekdays tend to have the highest completion rate.
Activity Heatmap	The last 12 weeks of check-ins, matching the Dashboard heatmap.
Countdowns	A place to add personal countdowns — anniversaries, trips, exams — separate from goals.



TIP

The **.ics** export is a convenient way to see HSG goal deadlines inside a phone's built-in calendar app without duplicating data entry.

 Time Blocking & Focus (Advanced Mode)

Inspired by tools such as Sunsama, Reclaim, and Motion, this tab plans a day in blocks rather than a flat list:

- **Time Blocking Planner** — add labelled blocks with a start and end time and a category (Work, Personal, Health, Rest), viewed as a timeline. Routine templates can be saved and re-applied to future days.
- **Focus Timer (Pomodoro)** — a configurable work/break timer based on the Pomodoro Technique developed by Francesco Cirillo, defaulting to 25 minutes of focus and 5 minutes of rest.

 Time Management Tools (Advanced Mode)

A broader toolkit for deciding what to do and when, drawn from established time-management frameworks:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Daily Highlight	Choose one priority task to anchor the day around, before the day fills up with smaller items.
Eat That Frog	Identifies the single most important, most-avoided task and prompts it to be done first.
2-Minute Rule Inbox	A quick-capture list for anything that takes under two minutes, to be cleared in a single short pass.
Not-To-Do List	A companion to the to-do list — habits and requests to deliberately decline.
Time Audit Log	Logs how time is actually spent, for comparison against how it was intended to be spent.
Weekly Time Budget	Allocates a target number of hours to each area of life for the week ahead.
Timeboxing Template Library	Ready-made timeboxed schedules for common day shapes.
Task Batching Planner	Groups similar small tasks together to reduce context-switching.
Energy-Level Scheduler	Matches demanding tasks to personal high-energy periods of the day.
Deadline Compressor	Works backward from a deadline to lay out the steps needed before it.
Time Leak Self-Audit	A short questionnaire for spotting where time quietly disappears each week.

 Time Management Education (Advanced Mode)

A reference tab summarising ideas from well-known writers on time and attention, including Cal Newport, Tim Ferriss, Laura Vanderkam, Greg McKeown, David Allen, Francesco Cirillo, and Parkinson's Law, among others.



TIP

Time-blocking one or two top priorities each day is generally easier to maintain than attempting to block an entire schedule.



TRACKING

To-Do & Checklists

For one-off tasks that do not belong in a long-term System, the To-Do page provides a straightforward checklist experience, organised into two tabs: **My Checklists** and **Template Library**.



To-Do Mini-Dashboard (Advanced Mode)

Summarises outstanding items with a completion breakdown and a chart of checklist sizes, so a quick glance shows both how much is left and how it is distributed across lists.



My Checklists

- Create multiple named checklists (for example, "Trip Packing" or "Weekly Errands") rather than a single flat list.
- Reorder, check off, and clear completed items within each checklist independently.
- An overview panel summarises progress across every checklist at once.



Template Library

A library of 508 pre-written checklists is available, searchable and filterable by category. Selecting one adds every item to a new checklist in a single step. Categories include:

Grocery & Food Household & Cleaning Wardrobe & Closet Tools & Workshop Travel & Packing Home & Moving
 How-To Guides Goals & Milestones Health & Self-Care Work & Productivity Events & Celebrations Pets
 Emergency & Safety Digital & Tech Fitness & Exercise Nutrition & Diet Mental & Emotional Health
 Sleep & Recovery Saving & Budgeting Debt Payoff Investing & Wealth Career & Job Search
 Professional Development Entrepreneurship Academic & School Lifelong Learning Relationships & Family
 Parenting Personal Growth Spirituality Creativity & Hobbies Community & Volunteering Life Transitions
 Environment & Sustainability Legal & Admin Bucket List Young Adult Life Retirement & Later Life


TIP

Reserve the To-Do list for genuinely one-off tasks. Recurring items are generally better suited to a System, which provides streak-tracking and consistency data in addition to a simple checkbox.



TRACKING

Analytics

The Analytics page provides a fuller set of trend lines and breakdowns than the Dashboard summary, making it easier to identify longer-term patterns.

CHART	WHAT IT SHOWS
Overall Completion Rate	A single gauge summarising completion across all goals.
Goals by Category / Status	Pie charts, matching the Dashboard's own breakdowns.
Completion Rate by Priority	Whether High-priority goals are actually finishing more often than Low.
System Consistency & Aggregate Systems Trend	Per-system and combined consistency over time.
Personal Records & All-Time Best Streaks	Longest streaks and other notable milestones ever recorded.
Best Days of the Week	Which weekdays show the strongest completion rate.
Goal Velocity	Goals completed per month over the last six months.
This Month vs. Last Month & Goal Category Trend	Month-over-month comparisons, overall and by category.
Full Year Activity Heatmap	A year-long version of the Dashboard's 12-week heatmap.

 Exporting Reports

- **Download PDF Report** — a printable one-page summary of goals and systems, using the same figures shown on the page.
- **Download Excel Workbook** (Advanced mode) — goals, systems, and checklists exported to separate spreadsheet tabs for further analysis.



NOTE

When reviewing Analytics, consider the overall trend line rather than any single low-performing day or week.



WELLNESS

Health & Fitness

This page brings physical health — movement, nutrition, and general wellbeing — into the same identity-and-systems framework used throughout HSG. Content is drawn from twenty influential books on the subject and organised into tabs.

 Core Tabs

TAB	CONTENTS
Interactive Tools	Calculators and trackers for everyday use — for example, hydration and workout logging.
Exercise, Mobility & Yoga	Reference routines and stretching sequences.
Diagrams & Charts	Visual reference material such as muscle groups and movement patterns.
Nutrition & Remedies	General nutrition guidance and common home-remedy reference notes.
Library — Top 20 Books	Summaries of twenty influential books on fitness and health.



NOTE

Fitness-related systems are commonly over-scoped at the outset. A shorter, consistently completed activity is generally more effective than a longer plan that is frequently postponed.

☀️ Extended Topic Tabs (Advanced Mode)

Seven further tabs, visible only in Advanced mode, group reference material by topic. Each opens its own set of sub-tabs:

Movement & Mind-Body

Recovery & Bodywork

Nutrition & Diet Approaches

Mental, Sleep & Lifestyle

Performance & Specialized Training

Alternative & Holistic

Tracking & Science

These tabs are intended as a browsable reference library rather than a single guided path — open whichever topic is relevant to the current interest, rather than working through them in order.

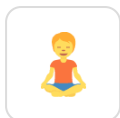
👍 Connecting Fitness to Systems

Health & Fitness does not track goals on its own; instead, movement and nutrition habits are best set up as ordinary entries on the Systems page, so they benefit from the same streak-tracking, Habit Stacker, and consistency charts as every other habit in HSG.



TIP

Use the Habit Template Library on the Systems page to add a fitness habit quickly, then return to this chapter's reference tabs for supporting detail as needed.



WELLNESS

Spirituality & Mental Health

This section provides tools for the reflective side of personal change — mindfulness, prayer, and mental wellbeing practices — supported by a reference library drawn from 41 texts on the subject.



Practice Tracking

- Log prayer, meditation, or contemplative practice sessions directly on this page.
- **Thematic Distribution** — a chart showing which themes across the 41-text library are drawn on most.
- **Spiritual Practices vs. Stress & Resilience Outcomes** — a chart comparing logged practice against a self-reported stress and resilience trend.
- **Your Own Practice & Mood Trend** — a personal trend line built from logged entries over time.



Prayer & Contemplative Practice

Structured guidance is provided for several contemplative practices, including step-by-step instructions for **Lectio Divina**, a traditional method of slow, reflective scripture reading.



Reading Library

A curated list of 40 books on spirituality and mental health is available for reference, alongside the 41-text thematic breakdown described above.

**NOTE**

This section is provided for personal reflection. Users should select whichever practices are relevant to their own circumstances and beliefs.



MONEY

Finance

Financial habits are treated as systems in HSG. The Finance page provides personal and business budgeting tools that feed directly into the Money Snapshot widget on the Dashboard. All figures stay on the local device.

Currency

A currency selector near the top of the page supports over 40 currencies, including USD, EUR, GBP, ZAR, JPY, CNY, INR, AUD, CAD, CHF, and many more. Every tool on the page uses the selected currency for display.

Three Categories

CATEGORY	CONTENTS
Finance Tools	Personal and business calculators and trackers, described over the next two pages.
Finance Education	A Personal Finance Library, a Business Finance Library, and a tab on Investment Systems.
Side Hustle & Small Business Ideas	A browsable list of income-generating ideas for reference.

Personal Finance Tools

The personal side of Finance Tools spans fifteen tabs:

Overview

Monthly Budget

50/30/20 Rule

Budgeting Systems

Savings Goal

Money Vision Board

Debt Payoff

Compound Interest

Net Worth

Recurring Bills

Cash Flow

Emergency Fund

Loan Calculator

Big Purchase Planner

Calculator

Two further Advanced-mode tabs round out the personal side: **Personal Money Tools**, a set of additional utilities, and **Cash Flow Quadrant**, a framework for classifying income sources as employee, self-employed, business owner, or investor income.



Selected Personal Tools in Detail

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Monthly Budget	Set planned income and category-based spending limits, then track actual spending against the plan.
50/30/20 Rule	Splits income into needs, wants, and savings using the well-known 50/30/20 guideline.
Debt Payoff	Models payoff timelines using either the snowball (smallest balance first) or avalanche (highest interest first) method.
Compound Interest	Projects the growth of savings or investments given a principal, contribution rate, interest rate, and time horizon.
Net Worth	Tracks total assets against total liabilities over time.
Recurring Bills	A list of regular payments with due dates, useful for spotting upcoming cash-flow pressure.
Emergency Fund	Calculates a target based on monthly expenses and tracks progress toward it.
Loan Calculator	Computes monthly payments and total interest for a loan given principal, rate, and term.
Big Purchase Planner	Plans a savings timeline toward a specific, larger purchase.



Business Finance Tools (Advanced Mode)

A separate set of tabs supports small-business finances, alongside the personal tools:

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES
Income Statement	Summarises revenue, expenses, and profit over a chosen period.
Balance Sheet	Lists business assets, liabilities, and equity at a point in time.
Business Money Tools	Further calculators for day-to-day business finance questions.
Business Finance Library	Reference material on managing a small business's finances.



TIP

A brief weekly budget review can be tracked as its own System on the Systems page. Regular, short reviews tend to prevent larger issues from developing.

Money Vision Board

A dedicated mini vision-board for financial goals, kept separate from the main Vision Board so that money-related aspirations can be reviewed alongside the budgeting tools that support them.

Finance Education

- **Personal Finance Library** — reference material on budgeting, saving, and everyday money management.
- **Business Finance Library** — reference material aimed at small-business owners.
- **Investment Systems** — an overview of common approaches to investing, presented as a systems-thinking topic consistent with the rest of HSG.

Side Hustle & Small Business Ideas

A browsable list of income-generating ideas, useful as a starting point when exploring additional income streams alongside a primary job.



NOTE

The Business tools are entirely optional. Users managing only personal finances can ignore the Business tabs without losing access to any personal tool.



PLANNING

Vision Board

The Vision Board provides a set of tools for defining the longer-term outcomes that systems and goals are ultimately working toward. It is organised into five tabs: **Vision Board**, **Best Possible Self & Ideal Day**, **Vision Tools**, **Core Values**, and **Teachings**.

✨ Daily Affirmations

Short, present-tense statements can be added and displayed alongside the board itself, to be read as a daily reminder of the identity being built.

🎨 The Board

Vision items can be filtered by category (**Career**, **Health**, **Finance**, **Learning**, **Personal**, **Relationship**), and the board's layout (Comfortable, Compact, Spacious) and background theme (Default, Warm, Cool, Dreamy, Minimal) can both be adjusted to taste. A **Present** button opens a full-screen slideshow of the board, useful for a quiet daily review.

📅 Life Timeline

Vision items that carry a target date are automatically laid out chronologically on a visual timeline, giving a single view of what is planned and when.

**TIP**

Pair each vision item with a short note on why it matters, not just what it is — the "why" is what keeps a vision board meaningful after the first few weeks.

Best Possible Self & Ideal Day

- **Best Possible Self** — a research-backed writing exercise: imagine life several years from now, with everything having gone as well as it possibly could, and write freely across each life area.
- **Ideal Day Visualization** — a guided prompt for describing an ordinary day within that envisioned future in specific, concrete detail.

Vision Tools

- **Core Values Clarifier** — a guided exercise for narrowing a long list of possible values down to the handful that matter most.
- **Vision Statement Builder** — assembles answers to a short set of prompts into a single, coherent vision statement.
- **Letter to My Future Self** — a private note written now, intended to be read again at a later, chosen date.

Core Values Tab

The same Core Values list maintained on the Identity page is accessible here as well, so vision items can be reviewed alongside the values they are meant to reflect.

Teachings

A reference tab of material on visualization and vision-setting, offered as supporting context for why these exercises are included in HSG.



NOTE

Review the Vision Board periodically rather than only once. As identity develops through consistent systems, the underlying vision may reasonably change as well.



PLANNING

Planning Tools

When a goal is larger than a single habit, Planning Tools provide a set of well-known strategic frameworks for thinking it through before committing. Eight tools are available to every user, with three further tabs in Advanced mode.

FRAMEWORK	BEST USED FOR
SWOT Analysis	Weighing Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats across four quadrants.
Eisenhower Matrix	Rating tasks by urgency and importance to decide what to do first, schedule, delegate, or drop.
Objectives & Key Results (OKR)	Pairing a qualitative objective with measurable key results.
Pros & Cons	A simple weighted list for a single decision.
Weekly Review	A guided checklist for a regular review of the past week and the week ahead.
Wheel of Life	Rating satisfaction across life areas on a radar-style chart to spot imbalance.
Ikigai	The Japanese framework for finding overlap between what is loved, what one is good at, what the world needs, and what can be paid for.
Decision Matrix	Scoring several options against weighted criteria side by side.

**TIP**

These frameworks work well as a one-time exercise before creating a large or ambiguous goal, and again periodically (for example, during a Weekly Review) once the goal is underway.

Advanced-Mode Tabs

Three further tabs are available in Advanced mode: **PM Concepts** (reference material on core project-management ideas), **Project Tools** (supporting utilities for active projects), and **PM Library** (a reading list on project management).

Gantt Charts

For projects with several interdependent steps, the Gantt Charts page provides a visual timeline of what needs to happen and when. It includes a library of 90 fully-editable templates across 18 categories, and a Gantt Mini-Dashboard (Advanced mode) summarising templates by category and the current project's tasks by status and priority.

Template categories include:

Software Development

Marketing Campaigns

Construction & Home

Events & Weddings

Business & Operations

Personal & Academic

and 12 further categories

- Every task on a Gantt chart carries its own owner, priority, status, and notes — not just a bar on a timeline.
- Each template comes with realistic default tasks, start offsets, and durations already filled in — for example, a Web App Launch template includes stages from Requirements Gathering through Post-Launch Monitoring.
- Templates can be filtered by category before selecting one to start a new project.
- A mini-dashboard at the top of the page keeps the active project's task breakdown visible while working.



NOTE

Gantt Charts are most useful for projects with dependencies — steps that must occur in a defined order. For simple, independent tasks, the To-Do & Checklists page is generally sufficient.



CONFIGURATION

Settings

The Settings page controls appearance, icons, data management, account details, and keyboard shortcuts, organised into six tabs.



Appearance

60 themes across 6 style families (Candy & Milky, High-Textured & Shiny, Plain & Solid Color, High Contrast, Multi-Color Tones, Black Dark), 10 layout presets, a full Colour Studio for per-surface colour overrides, adjustable text size (8–28px), font family, and comfortable vs. compact density.



Icons

10 icon set families (including Twemoji, Twemoji Classic, OpenMoji Color, OpenMoji Line Art, Noto Emoji, Noto Classic, Blobmoji, EmojiTwo, Toss Face, and EmojiOne Classic), each offered in 10 colour treatments — Classic, Ocean Duotone, Sunset Duotone, Vivid Pop, Muted Soft, High Contrast, Warm Glow, Cool Frost, Deep Shadow, and Neon Shift — for 100 combinations in total.



Data & Sync

Export a full backup or a shareable document, import a backup or spreadsheet, clear all data, or sync using a private GitHub repository with a fine-grained access token.



Account

View the current logged-in user and log out at any time; data remains stored on the device.



Shortcuts

Esc closes the active window, Enter submits a form, and Tab moves between fields.



GUI Map

A reference guide to the application's structure, useful when locating a specific feature.



CAUTION

"Clear All Data" is permanent and cannot be undone. Export a backup before using this option if the data may be needed again.



CAUTION

When using GitHub Sync, use a **private** repository and a fine-grained Personal Access Token limited to that single repository. This feature synchronises data; it does not encrypt it.



QUICK REFERENCE

Summary of Key Recommendations

A consolidated list of the recommendations from each chapter, for quick reference.

**START SMALL**

The smallest version of a habit that will actually be maintained is more effective than a more ambitious version that is abandoned after a short period.

**USE HABIT STACKING**

Attach new habits to existing, reliable ones using the Habit Stacker on the Systems page.

**PAIR EVERY GOAL WITH A SYSTEM**

A goal defines the destination; a system defines the method of reaching it. Link the two wherever possible.

**EVALUATE TRENDS, NOT SINGLE DATA POINTS**

When reviewing Analytics, consider the overall trend rather than any single low day or week.

**BACK UP BEFORE CLEARING DATA**

Always export data before using "Clear All Data" in Settings.

**REVIEW THE VISION BOARD PERIODICALLY**

Update the Vision Board every few months as goals and priorities evolve.

**CONFIGURE THE APPEARANCE**

Selecting a preferred theme, icon pack, and text size in Settings can improve day-to-day usability of the application.

**USE PLANNING FRAMEWORKS BEFORE LARGE GOALS**

Tools such as SWOT, OKR, or the Eisenhower Matrix on the Planning Tools page are most useful before committing to an ambiguous or large goal.



USER SUPPORT

Support & Contact



For questions, feedback, or assistance with HSG, contact support at the address below.

rdwerthen@gmail.com

? Frequently Asked Questions

? Where is my data stored?

All data entered into HSG is stored locally in the browser on the user's own device. No server is involved unless GitHub Sync has been configured in Settings.

? I cleared my data by mistake. Can it be recovered?

If a backup was exported beforehand, it can be restored from Settings > Data & Sync > Import. If no backup exists, the data cannot be recovered, which is why regular exports are recommended.

? Can HSG be used on a mobile device?

Yes. HSG runs in any modern browser, and the layout adapts for smaller screens; the sidebar is accessible via a menu icon on mobile.

? How do I switch between Basic and Advanced mode?

Use the site-mode switch near the top of the sidebar. Basic mode presents a simplified view; Advanced mode reveals additional tools and detail throughout the application.

? I found a defect, or have a suggestion for a new feature. What should I do?

Send a description of the issue or suggestion to rdwerthen@gmail.com, including the steps that led to it where applicable.

? Can this manual be downloaded again later?

Yes. The "Download User Manual" button is located at the bottom of the sidebar, below Settings.



HSG User Manual

Habits · Systems · Goals

rdwerthen@gmail.com